made by Atin

E3 Reading – Exam Prep Lesson 10: Linking words and what they tell you – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to use *because, so, but, however, also, although* and *if* to follow the ideas in a text, and to say what *this* and *these* point back to. This supports AC1.3 and AC1.1, and helps learners predict what comes next.

Materials: Handouts 10A, 10B and 10C, one per learner. Eight linking word cards for Activity 5, one set per group of four: *and, also, because, so, but, however, if, although*.

Activity 1: Four jobs (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Draw four boxes on the board labelled *add, reason, result, opposite*.
2. Say four sentences about yourself, pausing before the linking word: “I like coffee… and I like tea.” “I was late… because the train stopped.” “I was hungry… so I ate.” “I was tired… but I came to work.” After each, ask which box the linking word belongs in. Write it there.
3. Add the less common ones: *also* (add), *however* and *although* (opposite). Show that *however* starts a new sentence and has a comma after it.
4. Half-sentence game. Say the first half and the linking word; learners finish it: “I didn’t eat breakfast, so…” “I didn’t eat breakfast because…” “I didn’t eat breakfast, but…” Point out how the ending changes with each word.
5. Hand out 10A. Learners complete section A, matching the halves, then section B, choosing the correct word. Check in pairs, then on the board. For each item, ask which of the four jobs the word is doing.

Activity 2: What comes next? (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Do not hand out the text yet. Tell learners you will read a report about phones in schools and stop many times.
2. Read paragraph 2 of 10B aloud. Stop after *because*. Ask: “What comes next: a reason or a result?” Take guesses for the reason, then read on.
3. Stop after *They also*. Ask what kind of idea follows. Take guesses.
4. Read *However* at the start of paragraph 3 and stop. Ask: “Good news or a problem?” Establish that *however* means the opposite side is coming.
5. Continue in the same way through *so* in paragraph 4, *If* in paragraph 4 and *although* in paragraph 5.
6. Hand out 10B. Learners read silently and circle every linking word. Compare totals in pairs.

Activity 3: This, these, them (20 minutes)

1. Write on the board: *Some parents want to phone their children. The school listened to these worries.* Ask what *these worries* are. Draw the arrow back.
2. Explain that *this* and *these* often point back to a whole idea and not to one word. This is harder than *he* or *she*.
3. Learners find **them** in paragraph 1 and **these worries** in paragraph 4, and draw arrows.
4. Pairs explain to each other in their own words what the parents’ worries are.
5. Check as a class. Accept: they cannot contact their children; the journey home is long.

Activity 4: Exam questions (30 minutes)

1. Hand out 10C. Learners answer alone in 15 minutes.
2. Pairs compare and point to the linking word that helped, where there is one.
3. Class feedback. For question 5, show how *although a few still complain* makes *all* false. For question 8, show that *At first… But now…* signals a change.
4. Ask learners which two questions they could answer from the linking words alone.

Activity 5: Linking word story (20 minutes)

1. Groups of four. Put the eight linking word cards face down in the middle.
2. Give the first sentence: “Yesterday I lost my phone.”
3. Each learner in turn takes a card and must continue the story with a sentence that uses that word. The group decides if the sentence makes sense.
4. When the cards run out, shuffle and start a new story: “Last week my neighbour knocked on my door.”
5. Hear the best story from each group. Close by asking for the four jobs and one word for each.

Answer key, Lesson 10

- **10A Section A:** 1 C, 2 A, 3 D, 4 B, 5 F, 6 E. **Section B:** 1 so, 2 but, 3 because, 4 Also, 5 However.
- **10C:** 1 C. 2 B. 3 C. 4 B. 5 False. 6 A. 7 Students may use phones at the gate after 3.30pm. 8 C. 9 B.